

Classroom SEL pack, a week on belonging, ages 3 to 7

The Snug

A five-day plan with everything to print: word cards, a poster, a feelings chart, sequencing cards, activity cards, promise cards, an observation grid, exit tickets and family letters in five languages. The Home Activity Pack is included at the back.

Classroom licence: one teacher may print and copy this pack for their own class and students' families. Please don't share the file or post it online.

The week at a glance

About 20 to 30 minutes a day. Each day stands alone if you only have time for one.

Day	What you do	Print
Day 1 Read and learn the words	Read the story with the pause points. Teach the five words with gestures. Put up the poster and word cards.	Pages 3, 4, 5
Day 2 Feelings	Feelings check-in. Re-read the book and talk about how the characters felt, using the talk questions.	Pages 6, 9
Day 3 Retell	Mix up the sequencing cards and put the story back in order as a class. Retell with “First… Then… At the end…”.	Page 7
Day 4 Build a class Snug	Build a hut together over chairs, using pegs as ‘quills’. Everyone has a job: scoop (make the floor), loop (tie the string), snug (make it cosy). Make a sign for the door…	Page 8
Day 5 Who’s at the edge?	Who’s at the edge?, then promise cards and exit tickets. Send the family letter home.	Pages 8, 10, 14 to 16

Ontario Kindergarten frames

Belonging and Contributing, Self-Regulation and Well-Being, Problem Solving and Innovating, Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours

Materials

The book (or the class screen), a big blanket or sheet, string or ribbon, clothes pegs, paper lanterns

Also in this pack

All 12 pages of the Home Activity Pack (from page 17), which you may copy for your class. Book languages: English, French, Spanish, German, Italian.

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Day 1: the read-aloud

Before (3 minutes)

Show the cover. Ask: What are the animals doing? How do they look? Ask: Have you ever been new somewhere, like a new class or a new home? How did it feel? Take a few answers gently. Teach the refrain with actions: scoop (dig with your hands), loop (circle your arm), snug (hug yourself). ‘Scoop, loop, snug!’

During: stop, ask, listen (10 minutes)

Spread	What happens	Ask	Listen for
3	Quilla arrives; her quills stand up when she is shy.	How do you think Quilla feels being new?	shy, nervous, scared, excited
4	Everyone scoots away; Quilla sits alone.	How do you think Quilla felt sitting at the edge of the meadow?	sad, lonely, left out, cold
5	Bodie’s tummy flip-flops, but he crosses the meadow.	Why was it brave for Bodie to walk over and sit with her?	he was scared the others would leave him too
6	Quilla: ‘I’m done waiting to be asked.’	What did Quilla decide to do instead of waiting?	build their own warm place
7	A loose quill becomes a pin.	What were Quilla’s quills good for?	pins to hold the walls
8	Hazel asks, ‘Can I help?’	Why do you think the others wanted to join?	it looked fun, they wanted to help
10	‘Who is it for?’ ‘Everyone.’	Why do you think Quilla said the Snug was for everyone?	she remembered being left out, she didn’t want anyone to feel that way
11	The rabbit twins say sorry.	How do you think the twins feel at the door?	sorry, worried, hopeful

Spread numbers match the reader on the class screen. You don’t need every stop.

Handle with care: Some children in your class may be the ones at the edge. Read gently and never point anyone out. More notes on the “For every child” page.

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Word wall cards

Cut out and add to your word wall. Teach each word with its gesture.

snug

warm, cosy and comfortable

Do it: hug yourself and smile

shy

a bit scared to talk or join in

Do it: hide behind your hands

meadow

a big field of grass and flowers

Do it: sweep your hand flat and wide

vine

a long, bendy plant that climbs

Do it: wiggle your arm upward

welcome

happy to have someone come in

Do it: open your arms wide

Scoop, loop, snug!

Say it together whenever it comes up in the story.

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If there’s no room for you, build a place with room for everyone.

Scoop, loop, snug!

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How do you feel today?

Post at circle time. Children clip a peg with their name on a face.
Characters' feelings change during a story, and ours can too.



happy

clip your name here



sad

clip your name here



worried

clip your name here



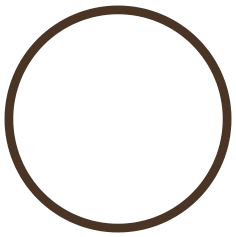
angry

clip your name here



proud

clip your name here



something else

clip your name here

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Sequencing cards

Cut apart for the pocket chart. The four scenes come from the start, two middles and the end of the book, mixed up. Put them in order and retell. Children can color them too.









Answer key, top left to bottom right: 3, 1, 4, 2.

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Activity cards

Cut out and keep with the book. Use one on Day 4 and one on Day 5, or any time.

Build a class Snug

20 minutes, Whole class, Materials: A big sheet, chairs, string, clothes pegs

Build a hut together over chairs, using pegs as ‘quills’. Everyone has a job: scoop (make the floor), loop (tie the string), snug (make it cosy). Make a sign for the door: ‘For everyone.’

Who’s at the edge?

10 minutes, Whole class, Materials: None

Talk about how you can tell when someone feels left out (sitting alone, looking down). Practise what Bodie did: walk over, sit down, say ‘Hello.’

Acorn lanterns

15 minutes, Individual, Materials: Paper, crayons, string

Make a small paper lantern and write or draw one way you can make room for someone new. Hang them by the class door.

Science and nature corner

Porcupine quills are special stiff hairs. Porcupines can’t shoot them, but loose quills come out easily. Some porcupines, like the North American porcupine that lives in Canada, are good tree climbers. European badgers live in family groups in underground homes with lots of tunnels and rooms, called setts. Moles live almost all their lives underground and dig with wide front paws.

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Talk together

Use after reading, at circle time or with a small group. Accept every honest answer.

1. How do you think Quilla felt sitting at the edge of the meadow?

Look for: Lonely, sad, cold, left out. Accept any feeling word.

2. Why was it brave for Bodie to walk over and sit with her?

Look for: He was nervous the others might scoot away from him too.

3. What did Quilla decide to do instead of waiting?

Look for: Build a warm place of her own with Bodie.

4. Why do you think she said the Snug was for everyone?

Look for: She knew how it felt to be left out.

5. Is there someone who might like you to sit with them?

Look for: Any answer. Invite children to try it at lunch or play.



Say it together

Scoop, loop, snug!

The big idea: If there's no room for you, you can make a place, and then make room for everyone, even those who left you out.

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Promise cards

Each child writes or draws one way they can show belonging this week.
Hang them up, then check back on Friday.



I can show belonging by

Name _____



I can show belonging by

Name _____



I can show belonging by

Name _____



I can show belonging by

Name _____

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What to look for

Tick what you notice during the week. Each column names the Ontario frame it shows.

Child	Belonging and Contributing	Self-Regulation and Well-Being	Problem Solving and Innovating	Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours	Notes

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Science and place corner

Bramble Hollow is made up, so we picked a real place where crested porcupines, badgers, red squirrels and moles all live: the Casentino Forests National Park in Italy. It's one of the few places in Europe where you can meet a porcupine!



Crested porcupine

Porcupines can't shoot or throw their quills. They only come loose when something touches them.



European badger

In Italy, cameras have filmed badgers, porcupines and foxes using the very same burrows.



Red squirrel

One red squirrel may eat the seeds from up to 20,000 pine cones in a year.



Wood mouse

When something scares it, a wood mouse can leap high in the air.



European mole

Moles store spare earthworms in an underground larder, biting them so they can't crawl away.



European rabbits

A European rabbit can run up to 56 km/h.

Casentino Forests, Italy

Quilla: Real crested porcupines live on the ground and don't climb trees like Quilla does. They are also much bigger than a badger! But badgers and porcupines in Italy really do share homes.

Bodie: Real badgers really are amazing diggers, just like Bodie. The blue knitted hat is our artist's idea!

Hazel: Real red squirrels love moss for their nests, so Hazel's roof job fits! Her acorn-cup cap is our artist's idea.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-snug

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For every child

English and French learners

Watch the read-aloud first. Teach ‘Hello’, ‘Can I help?’ and ‘Come in!’ with gestures. The refrain has three action words, so everyone can join.

Children who need more support

Use three stops (spreads 4, 6 and 10). Act out ‘scooting away’ and ‘sitting beside’ with puppets.

Newcomer children

This story fits a new school or a move. Pair a newcomer with a buddy, and let both be builders in the class Snug.

Handle with care

Some children in your class may be the ones at the edge. Read gently and never point anyone out.

The rabbits’ sorry is a kind repair, not the reason they are let in. The door was already open to everyone.

Nobody is welcomed because they turn out to be useful. Quilla belongs because she is Quilla.

Where this value comes from

This story doesn’t come from one culture. Many traditions have words for the warm feeling of belonging that grows from small kind acts, like jeong in Korea, and for a community that makes room for every family.

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Family letters

Cut apart and send home in the family's language, or copy the text into your newsletter.



English

Today we read The Snug, a story about belonging. Quilla the porcupine is left out, so she builds a warm place of her own, and makes it open to everyone. At home, talk with your child about a time they felt new or left out, and about one way they could make room for someone else. You can watch or read the story together for free at doubleadventure.ca.



Français

Aujourd'hui, nous avons lu Le Cocon, une histoire sur le sentiment d'appartenance. Quilla la porc-épic est mise de côté, alors elle construit son propre lieu bien chaud, ouvert à tout le monde. À la maison, parlez avec votre enfant d'une fois où il s'est senti nouveau ou mis de côté, et d'une façon de faire de la place à quelqu'un d'autre. Vous pouvez lire ou regarder l'histoire gratuitement sur doubleadventure.ca.



Español

Hoy leímos un cuento sobre sentirse parte de un grupo. A Quilla, la puercoespín, la dejan de lado, así que construye su propio lugar cálido y lo abre para todos. En casa, hablen de una vez en que su hijo o hija se sintió nuevo o excluido, y de una forma de hacer lugar a otra persona. Pueden leer o ver el cuento gratis en doubleadventure.ca.

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Family letters

Continued.



Deutsch

Heute haben wir eine Geschichte über das Dazugehören gelesen. Das Stachelschwein Quilla wird ausgeschlossen, also baut es sich einen eigenen warmen Ort und öffnet ihn für alle. Sprechen Sie zu Hause mit Ihrem Kind über ein Mal, als es neu war oder sich ausgeschlossen fühlte, und darüber, wie es selbst Platz für andere machen kann. Die Geschichte gibt es kostenlos auf doubleadventure.ca.



Italiano

Oggi abbiamo letto una storia sul sentirsi parte di un gruppo. Quilla, la piccola istrice, viene lasciata da parte, così costruisce un posto caldo tutto suo e lo apre a tutti. A casa, parlate con vostro figlio o vostra figlia di una volta in cui si è sentito nuovo o escluso, e di un modo per fare spazio a qualcun altro. Potete leggere o guardare la storia gratis su doubleadventure.ca.

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Exit tickets

Read each line aloud. Children tick what they can do and circle a face.
Four tickets per page.

Name _____

Belonging: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Belonging: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Belonging: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

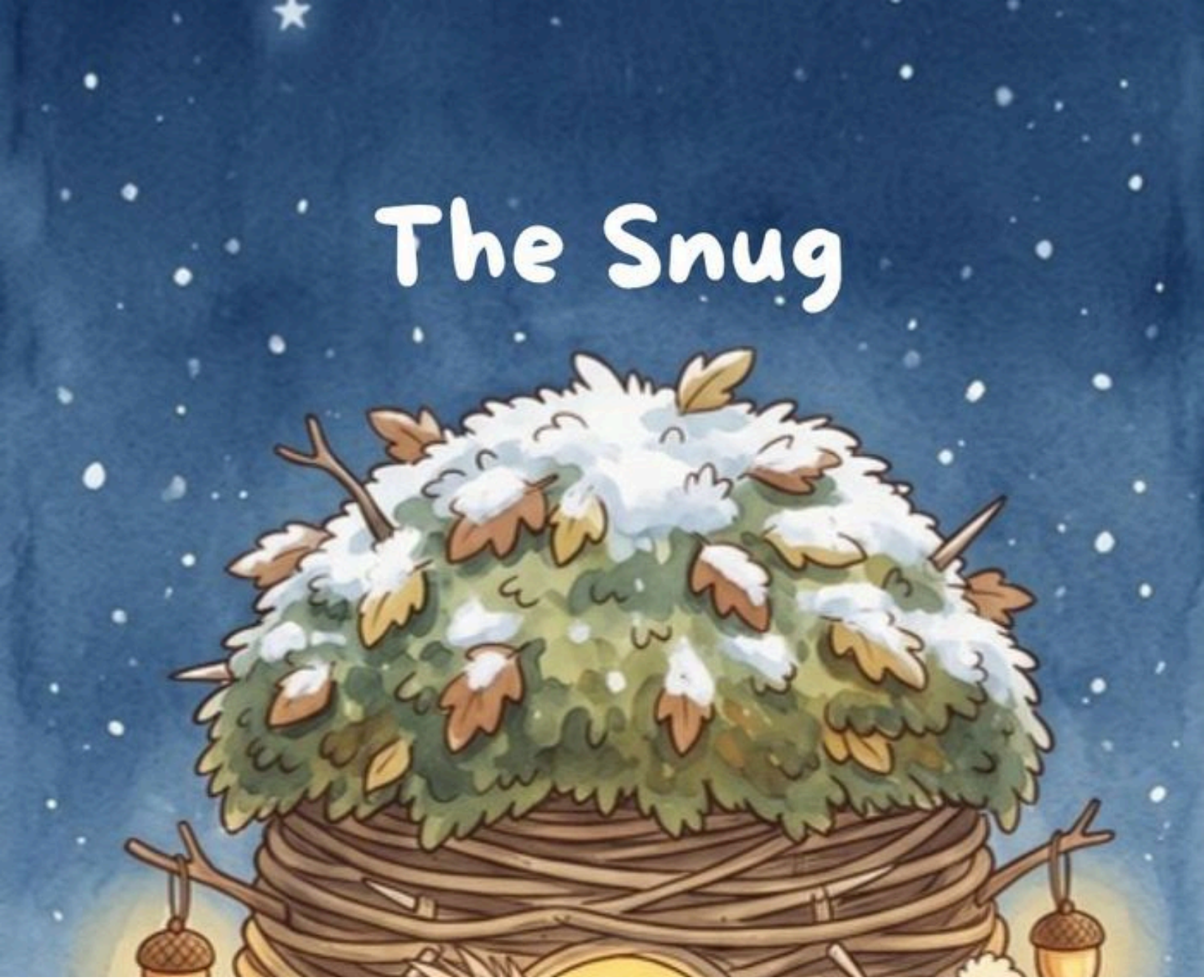
Belonging: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

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Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

The Snug

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: belonging.

For use in your own home. Please don’t share the file or post it online.

For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

If there's no room for you, you can make a place, and then make room for everyone, even those who left you out.

Say it together

Scoop, loop, snug!

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
snug	warm, cosy and comfortable	hug yourself and smile
shy	a bit scared to talk or join in	hide behind your hands
meadow	a big field of grass and flowers	sweep your hand flat and wide
vine	a long, bendy plant that climbs	wiggle your arm upward
welcome	happy to have someone come in	open your arms wide

A gentle note

The rabbits' sorry is a kind repair, not the reason they are let in. The door was already open to everyone.

Nobody is welcomed because they turn out to be useful. Quilla belongs because she is Quilla.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Quilla

Crested porcupine

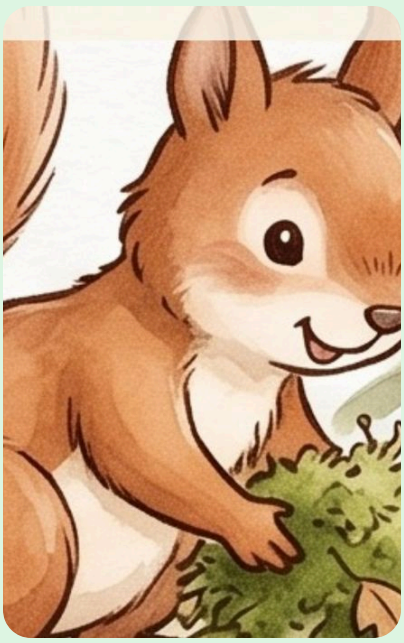
The new girl who builds a place with room for everyone



Bodie

European badger

The first friend to cross the meadow



Hazel

Red squirrel

Piles soft moss on the roof



Thimble

Wood mouse

Ties every vine with tiny knots



Mossy

European mole

Pops up and smooths the floor



Fern and Fig

European rabbits

The twins who scooted, then said sorry

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How did they feel?

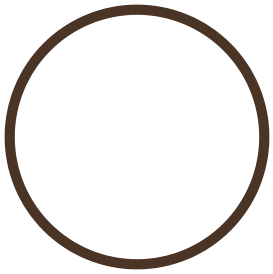
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

Quilla arrives; her quills stand up when she is shy.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

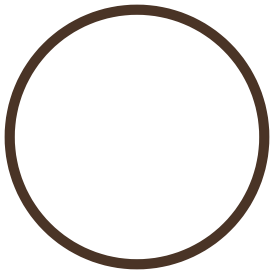


Moment 2

A loose quill becomes a pin.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

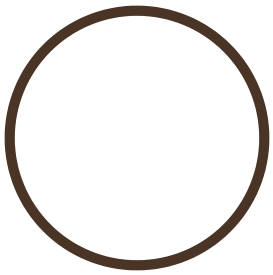


Moment 3

The rabbit twins say sorry.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



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Story in order

Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

snug warm, cosy and comfortable

snug snug

shy a bit scared to talk or join in

shy shy

meadow a big field of grass and flowers

meadow meadow

Quilla the hero of the story

Quilla Quilla

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Quilla showed belonging. Draw a time when you showed belonging too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

Acorn lanterns

You need: Paper, crayons, string

Make a small paper lantern and write or draw one way you can make room for someone new. Hang them by the class door.

Build a snug

Make a cosy den with cushions and blankets. Who will you invite in?

Badger bedding

Badgers change their bedding often. Help a grown-up shake out a blanket and make a fresh bed.

Thump warning

Play rabbits: when the 'fox' comes, thump your foot and everyone freezes!

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in The Snug are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Quilla

Crested porcupine

Porcupines can't shoot or throw their quills. They only come loose when something touches them.



Bodie

European badger

In Italy, cameras have filmed badgers, porcupines and foxes using the very same burrows.



Hazel

Red squirrel

One red squirrel may eat the seeds from up to 20,000 pine cones in a year.



Thimble

Wood mouse

When something scares it, a wood mouse can leap high in the air.

Story or real?

Real crested porcupines live on the ground and don't climb trees like Quilla does. They are also much bigger than a badger! But badgers and porcupines in Italy really do share homes.

Where they really live

Bramble Hollow is made up, so we picked a real place where crested porcupines, badgers, red squirrels and moles all live: the Casentino Forests National Park in Italy. It's one of the few places in Europe where you can meet a porcupine!

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-snug

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

What are the animals doing? How do they look?

The Snug, talk card 1

How do you think Quilla felt sitting at the edge of the meadow?

The Snug, talk card 2

Why was it brave for Bodie to walk over and sit with her?

The Snug, talk card 3

What did Quilla decide to do instead of waiting?

The Snug, talk card 4

Why do you think she said the Snug was for everyone?

The Snug, talk card 5

Is there someone who might like you to sit with them?

The Snug, talk card 6

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Belonging hero

This is to say that

_____

showed belonging, just like Quilla.

Scoop, loop, snug!

_____ _____

Signed Date

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